

The Garamut "The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'!

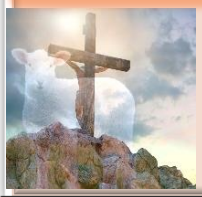
For PRAYER, PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL PROGRESS

Bethel Global Missions

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THEME: A GOSPEL WITHOUT A LAMB



HOW IS IT POSSIBLE THAT THE GOOD GOSPEL IS PRESENTED AND PREACHED WITHOUT ANY REFERENCE TO THE LAMB OF GOD THAT TAKES AWAY THE SIN OF THE WORLD.

John 1:29 The next day John saw Jesus coming toward him and said, "Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world! NIV

TOO OFTEN THE GOSPEL IS BEING SPOKEN, PRESENTED AND PREACHED WITHOUT ANY REFERENCE TO THE SACRIFICIAL LAMB (JESUS CHRIST) WHO SUFFERED, DIED, SHED HIS BLOOD TO PROVIDE THE FORGIVENESS OF OUR SIN FOR ALL MANKIND.

SADLY, THE GOSPEL TODAY IS MORE OF A HUMANITARIAN AND SOCIAL GOSPEL THAT IS WITHOUT THE REDEMPTIVE ASPECTS OF CHRIST'S DEATH ON THE CROSS.

THE SACRIFICIAL LAMB AND HIS CROSS ARE NO LONGER THE CENTRAL FACTOR OF THE GOSPEL; IT IS SIMPLY NOT MENTIONED.

THIS IS A GOSPEL THAT CAUSES NO OFFENCE.

OFTEN THE CROSS AND CHRIST'S SUFFERING IS NOT PRESENTED FOR FEAR THAT IT WILL OFFEND PEOPLE, and the apostle refers to this in Galatians 5:11-

"If I were no longer preaching salvation through the cross of Christ, no one would be offended". NLT

Galatians 5:11 Now brothers, if I still preach circumcision, why am I still persecuted? In that case the offense of the cross has been abolished. Holman.

THE "OFFENSE OF THE CROSS" MEANS THAT THE MESSAGE OF JESUS DYING FOR HUMAN SIN COMPLETELY DESTROYS HUMAN PRIDE, SELF-RIGHTEOUSNESS, AND THE BELIEF THAT PEOPLE CAN EARN THEIR WAY TO GOD.

SO, THIS IS WHY THE SACRIFICE, DEATH, SUFFERING, AND SHED BLOOD OF THE LAMB (CHRIST) WAS VIEWED AS BEING OFFENSIVE.

SAVALTION AND DELIVERANCE WITHOUT A LAMB is not POSSIBLE.

If the Israelites were to be saved and delivered from the plague that God was sending on every Egyptian home – 'of death on the first born', then according to God's command, there must be a sacrificial lamb killed and its blood placed over the door post of every Israelite house, and so that when GOD SAW THE BLOOD, DEATH WOULD PASSOVER - ISRAEL WOULD BE SAVED - hence the name the "Passover lamb".

*Exodus 12:3 Tell the whole community of Israel that on the tenth day of this month **each man is to take a lamb** for his family, one for each household. NIV*

CHRIST'S GOSPEL IS THE SAME.

THERE HAS TO BE A SACRIFICIAL LAMB IF THERE IS TO BE ANY SALVATION AND DELIVERANCE FROM THE PENALTY AND POWER AND OF SIN.

THE PENALTY OF SIN IS INDEPENDENCE AND SEPARATION FROM GOD ETERNALLY (dead spiritually).

The POWER OF SIN IS, ITS CONTROL OVER HUMAN DESIRES.

THESE TWO THINGS ARE BECAUSE MAN HAS TRANSGRESSED / BROKEN GOD'S LAW.

WE HAVE BEEN COMPLETELY FREED FROM BOTH THROUGH *"the Lamb of God, Who takes away the sin of the world! AMP John 1:29.*

THERE CAN BE NO FORGIVENESS OF SIN WITHOUT THE SHED BLOOD OF THE LAMB OF GOD – CHRIST.

Colossians 1:14 in whom we have redemption through His blood, the forgiveness of sins. NKJV.
Hebrews 9:22 In fact, the law requires that nearly everything be cleansed with blood, and without the shedding of blood there is no forgiveness.
NIV
Romans 5:9 Much more then, having now been justified by His blood, we shall be saved from wrath through Him. NKJV.

THERE CAN BE NO RECONCILIATION AND JUSTIFICATION WITHOUT THE DEATH AND RESURRECTION OF CHRIST.

Romans 3:24 being justified freely by His grace through the redemption that is in Christ Jesus. NKJV.
Romans 5:10 For if when we were enemies we were reconciled to God through the death of His Son, much more, having been reconciled, we shall be saved by His life. NKJV.

ISAAC QUESTIONED - WHERE IS THE LAMB?

Isaac asked his father Abraham - *Genesis 22:7-8*
*7 Isaac spoke up and said to his father Abraham, "Father?" "Yes, my son?" Abraham replied. "The fire and wood are here," Isaac said, **"BUT WHERE IS THE LAMB for the burnt offering?"***
*8 Abraham answered, **"God himself will provide THE LAMB for the burnt offering,** my son." And the two of them went on together. NIV*

THE BURNT OFFERING
The burnt offering in the Bible is a voluntary sacrifice entirely consumed by fire on an altar, symbolizing total surrender, devotion, and atonement before God.
Isaac questioned the absence of the sacrificial lamb, which was essential for a valid offering.

THE WOOD AND THE FIRE
Isaac and Abram had provided the wood and the fire, in preparation for the burnt offering to God, but these two elements were meaningless without the sacrificial lamb.

THE SAME QUESTION TO MUST BE ASKED TODAY –
'WHERE IS THE LAMB' IN THE GOSPEL OF JESUS CHRIST?

For the gospel of salvation to be a valid one, there has to be a lamb that give its life in order to redeem the sinner from sin.
2 Corinthians 5:21 For God made Christ, who never sinned, to be the offering for our sin, so that we could be made right with God through Christ. NLT.

THE GOSPEL IS THE RESULT OF GOD'S LOVE FOR US – BUT IT IS MORE THAN JUST LOVE FOR MANKIND AND LOVE FOR ONE ANOTHER.
It's about a savour that came specifically to die in the sinner's place – to be his substitute bearing his shame, degradation and ultimate punishment for sin, so that Christ Jesus could justly (according to the law of God) provide salvation and forgiveness for every sinner.

BUT SADLY, JESUS IS BEING SPOKEN OF ONLY AS A GOOD MAN, A TEACHER, EVEN A PROPHET AND ONE WHO LOVED US.

BUT HIS ROLE AS THE LAMB OF GOD WHO TAKES AWAY THE SINS OF THE WORLD IS MISSING.

- **THERE IS NO MENTION OF HIS SACRIFICE AND SUFFERING AND TERRIBLE CRUEL SCOURGING AND DEATH.**
- **THERE IS NO MENTION OF HIS SHED BLOOD POURED OUT FOR OUR FORGIVENESS, RECONCILIATION AND RESTORATION BACK TO GOD.**
- **THERE IS NO REFERENCE TO GOD'S AMAZING GIFT – HIS ONLY SON AS THE LAMB OF GOD.**

AMEN! PS BARRY